آغا خان یونیورسٹی ایگزامینیشن بورڈ

AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION BOARD

Notes from E-Marking Centre on HSSC-II Commercial Geography Annual Examinations 2025

Introduction

This document has been produced for the teachers and candidates of Higher Secondary School Certificate (HSSC) Part II Commercial Geography. It contains comments on candidates' responses to the 2025 HSSC-II Examination indicating the quality of the responses and highlighting their relative strengths and weaknesses.

E-Marking Notes

This includes overall comments on candidates' performance on every question and *some* specific examples of candidates' responses that support the mentioned comments. Please note that the descriptive comments represent an overall perception of the better and weaker responses as gathered from the e-marking session. However, the candidates' responses shared in this document represent some specific example(s) of the mentioned comments.

Teachers and candidates should be aware that examiners may ask questions that address the Student Learning Outcomes (SLOs) in a manner that requires candidates to respond by integrating knowledge, understanding and application skills they have developed during study. Candidates are advised to read and comprehend each question carefully before writing the response to fulfil the demand of the question.

Candidates need to be aware that the marks allocated to the questions are related to the answer space provided on the examination paper as a guide to the length of the required response. A longer response will not in itself lead to higher marks. Candidates need to be familiar with the command words in the SLOs which contain terms commonly used in examination questions. However, candidates should also be aware that not all questions will start with or contain one of the command words. Words such as 'how', 'why' or 'what' may also be used. It is imperative to refer to the command word guide available on AKU-EB website for understanding the expectations of the command word.

General Observations

The overall performance of candidates in Commercial Geography was good, with a majority demonstrating a clear understanding of fundamental concepts and the ability to apply geographic knowledge in commercial contexts. However, a notable variation in performance was observed across different sections of the paper.

Candidates performed well and showed good knowledge on topics such as the significance of Commercial Geography and its connection to trade and commerce, types of economic activities, the economic role of water and power resources, the economic benefits of the tourism industry, climate change, soil erosion, the impact of harsh weather on commercial activities, the contribution of lumbering industries, modes of transportation, and factors of migration. Most of them understood the basic idea of these topics and were able to write about it.

Candidates faced challenges in topics related to the famous regions for animal or cattle farming, feasible conditions for cultivation.

Note: Candidates' responses shown in this report have not been corrected for grammar, spelling, format, or information.

DETAILED COMMENTS

Constructed Response Questions (CRQs)

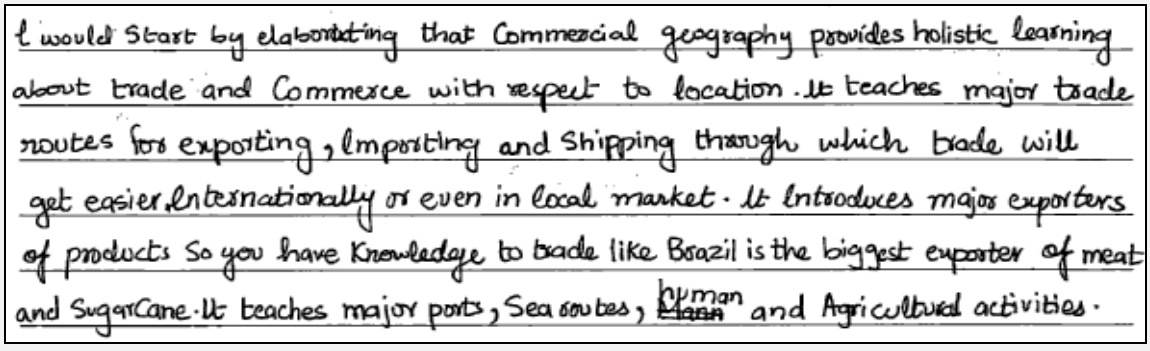
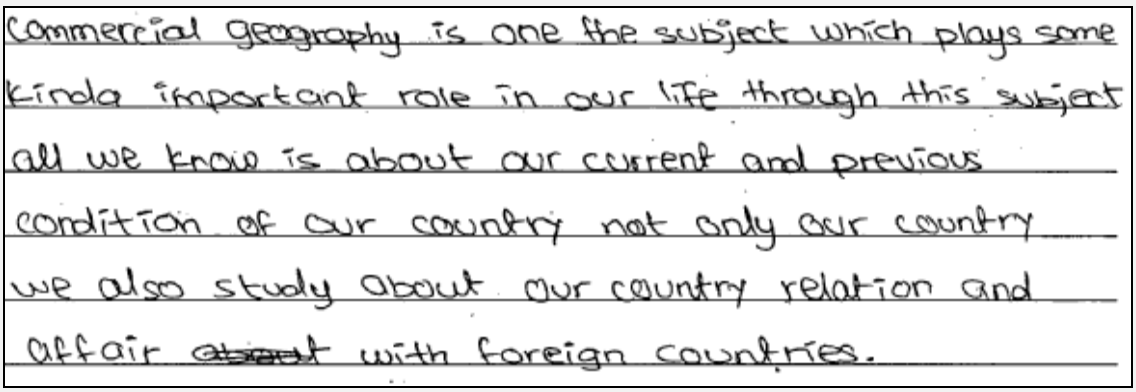
Question No. 1	
Question Text	A classmate of yours is struggling to grasp the importance of Commercial Geography at the HSSC II level. He/ she is unable to understand the subject's relation to real life and current events. Therefore, he/ she believes that it should be replaced with some other valuable subject. Based on the given scenario, how would you explain the significance of studying commercial geography and its connection to trade and commerce?
SLO No.	1.3.1
SLO Text	Discuss the scope and significance of commercial geography.
Max Marks	3
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE Mark for mentioning (how study of Commercial Geography connects to real life, the economy and trade and commerce) for each point of significance. (THREE required).
Overall Performance	Most of the candidates performed well by highlighting the significance of learning Commercial Geography. They emphasised its real-life applications, its role in understanding economic activities such as trade and commerce, raising awareness about global economies, and supporting efficient resource planning and utilisation. However, a few did not meet the criteria or fully addressed the question.
Description of Better Responses	Most candidates excelled in this question by effectively highlighting the significance of learning Commercial Geography. These responses demonstrated a clear understanding of its importance, particularly in relation to trade and commerce, and they successfully mentioned the three required points. These answers included points such as assisting in identifying the target market and improving the balance of payments by trading with leading exporters of different goods etc.
Image of Better Response	 I would start by elaborating that Commercial geography provides holistic learning about trade and Commerce with respect to location. It teaches major trade routes for exporting, Importing and Shipping through which trade will get easier, Internationally or even in local market. It introduces major exporters of products so you have Knowledge to trade like Brazil is the biggest exporter of meat and SugarCane. It teaches major ports, Sea routes, human and Agricultural activities.
Description of Weaker Responses	A few candidates did not perform well on this question. Their responses were generally vague, with some candidates repeating the same points without making relevant connections. These responses did not directly link Commercial Geography to trade, commerce, or economic activities, which were central to the question prompt. Candidates also failed to provide any concrete examples of how Commercial Geography relates to trade, such as import/export, transportation, or economic zones. Instead, their answers included generic points like "it is helpful in increasing trade" or "it develops infrastructure."

Image of Weaker Response	 Commercial geography is one the subject which plays some kinda important role in our life through this subject all we know is about our current and previous condition of our country not only our country we also study about our country relation and affair ~~about~~ with foreign countries.

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

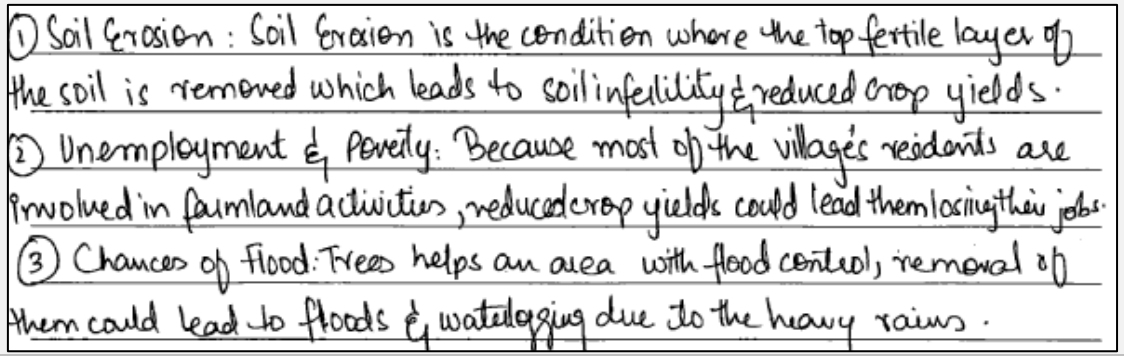
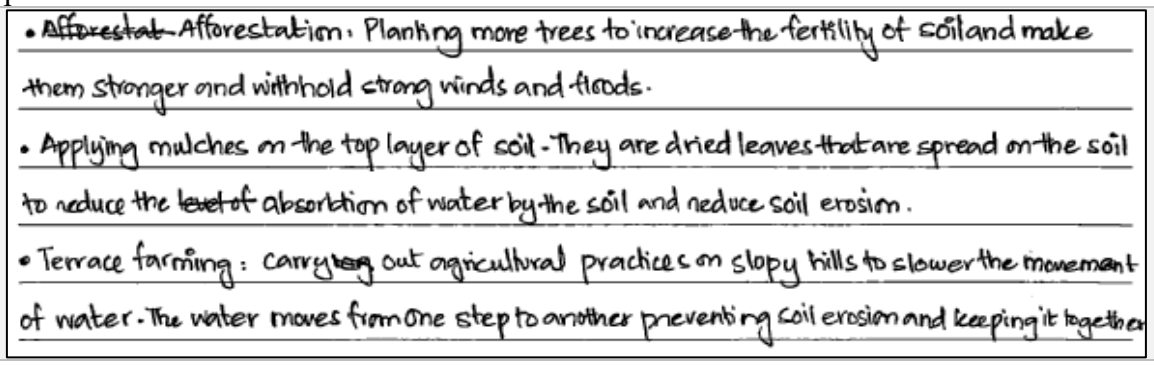
Maximising SLO Achievement	Preferred Pedagogy** Used for this SLO	Assessment Strategies
• Identify the expectation of command words (use Command Word Guide) • Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level • Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review of past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Story Board • Cause and Effect • Fish and Bone • Concept Mapping • Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share • Practical Demonstration ** For description of each Pedagogy, refer to Annexure A	• Past paper questions • Discussion on E-Marking Notes

Any Additional Suggestion

Incorporate local and global trade examples (e.g., Pakistan–China CPEC, textile exports) to help candidates relate Commercial Geography to current events.
Begin with real-life examples and short videos to explain issues such as global warming and its local impact.
Encourage brainstorming sessions where candidates suggest practical individual actions.
Use activities such as role-plays, group discussions, and poster-making to promote eco-friendly habits.
Introduce a word bank with subject-specific terms (e.g.,globalisation, trade networks, balance of trade) and encourage its use in discussions and written responses.

*K = Knowledge U = Understanding A = Application and other higher-order cognitive skills

Question No. 2	
Question Text	Mehrab-pur is a small village nestled in a fertile valley, known for its rich soil and prosperous agricultural activities. The village's economy is heavily dependent on farming, with most of its residents engaged in growing crops like wheat, corn and vegetables. The villagers have also been engaged in deforestation to expand their farmlands, removing trees that once held the soil together. Over the past few years, the village has been experiencing unseasonably heavy rains and stronger winds, partly due to climate change. In light of given scenario, discuss any THREE problems that can arise for the villagers.
SLO No.	2.3.6
SLO Text	Discuss the adverse effects of soil erosion with reference to economy.
Max Marks	3

Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for each problem (THREE required)
Overall Performance	The question was generally answered well, and most candidates met its requirements by clearly highlighting the impact of adverse weather on the farmland. Few responses, focused more on the impact and causes of climate change on the environment or repeated the climate-related details already given in the question, instead of providing relevant suggestions
Description of Better Responses	The majority of candidates performed well, successfully highlighting the problems faced by villagers due to heavy rain. Their responses addressed the major issues, meeting the question's requirements and demonstrating strong understanding and analytical skills. These responses included points like soil erosion, unexpected rain or harsh weather conditions, loss of livelihood due to uncertain weather, flooding of farmland etc.
Image of Better Responses	
Description of Weaker Responses	Most weaker responses listed suggestions but failed to discuss the actual problems, particularly those faced by farmers due to heavy rains and changing weather conditions. This revealed a misunderstanding of the question posed. Few weaker responses showed difficulty in connecting problems to the given scenario, with many candidates listing suggestions instead of identifying the actual problems. There were repetitions of similar points in few responses like "crop loss" and "less farming" were mentioned as two separate points.
Image of Weaker Responses	

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

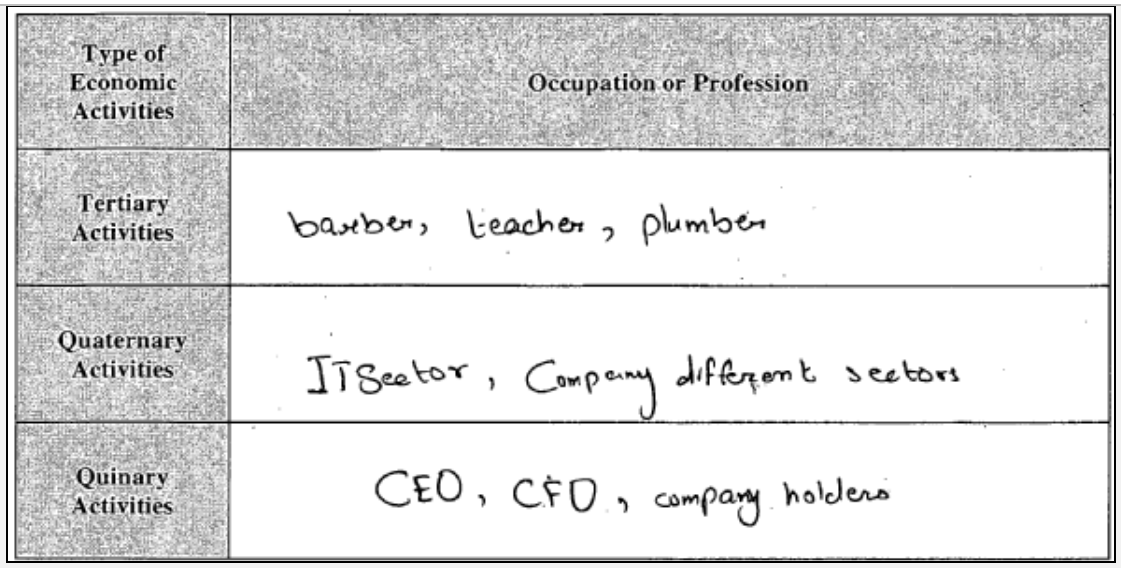
Maximising SLO Achievement	Preferred Pedagogy Used for this SLO	Assessment Strategies
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• Review past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) • Practical Demonstration	

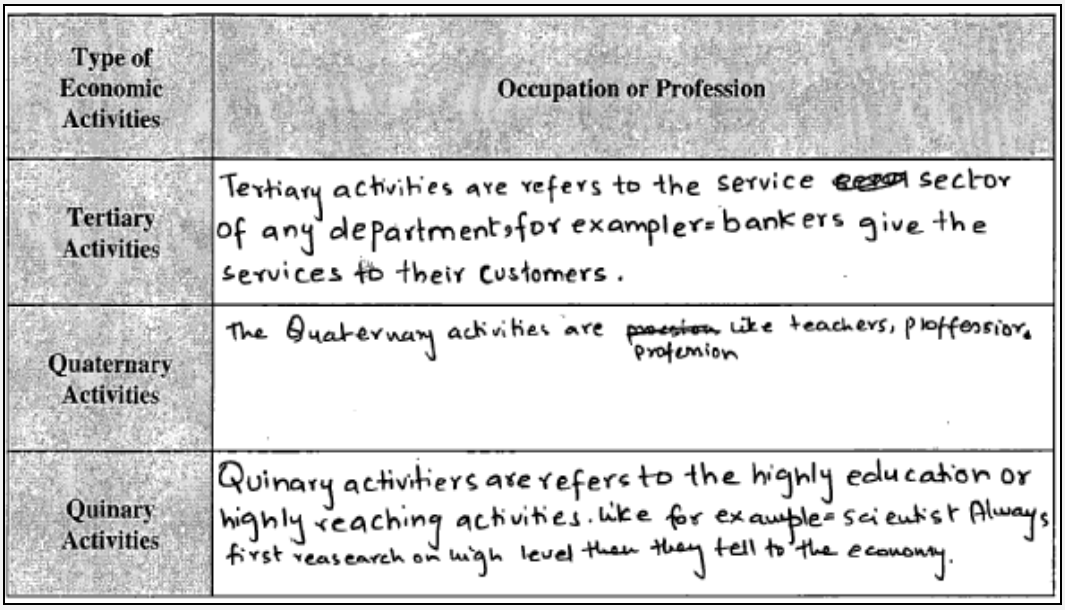
Any Additional Suggestion: Use concept maps to outline the chain of causes and effects related to erosion. Show how different control measures address particular causes of erosion. Encourage candidates to create their own diagrams to reinforce understanding.

Question No. 3

Question Text	Exemplify the following types of economic activities with any ONE occupation or profession for each. **Type of Economic Activities** / **Occupation or Profession** **Tertiary Activities** **Quaternary Activities** **Quinary Activities**
SLO No.	3.2.2
SLO Text	Exemplify different types of economic activities: • primary activities (raw materials) • secondary activities (manufacturing and industries) • tertiary activities (service sector) • quaternary activities (knowledge sector) • quinary sector (decision making sector)
Max Marks	3
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE Mark for one occupation or profession of each (THREE required).
Overall Performance	This question was conceptually straightforward, but candidates' performance did not reflect their perceived simplicity. Some responses reflected the confusion between Quaternary and Quinary activities and mentioned the examples under wrong activity. Few candidates instead of giving examples wrote the definitions of economic activities instead of examples, which reflected lack of understanding of exemplify as a command word.
Description of Better Responses	Most candidates demonstrated strong familiarity with economic activities and provided appropriate examples in their responses. Better responses included examples like "Teacher" or "Bank Manager" for **Tertiary activities**, "Software Developer" or "Data Analyst" for **Quaternary activities**, and "CEO" or "Government Minister" for **Quinary activities**. These answers showed understanding of the hierarchy and functions within the economy.
Image of Better Response	



Type of Economic Activities	Occupation or Profession
Tertiary Activities	barber, teacher, plumber
Quaternary Activities	IT Seetor, Company different seetors
Quinary Activities	CEO, CFO, company holders

Description of Weaker Responses	Most of the w*eaker responses* defined the economic sectors instead of exemplifying them. Some candidates provided incorrect examples or repeated or gave vague examples such as "Teacher" for all three categories, or listing jobs like "Farmer" or "Shopkeeper" under Quinary, which indicated confusion or guesswork. Some candidates also left parts of the question blank or listed sectors instead of occupations (e.g., "Education" instead of "Teacher").
Image of Weaker Response	

Type of Economic Activities	Occupation or Profession
Tertiary Activities	Tertiary activities are refers to the service ~~sector~~ sector of any departments for examples bankers give the services to their customers.
Quaternary Activities	The Quaternary activities are ~~profession~~ like teachers, ploffessior, profemion
Quinary Activities	Quinary activitiers are refers to the highly education or highly reaching activities. like for example= scientist Always first reasearch on high level then they tell to the economy.

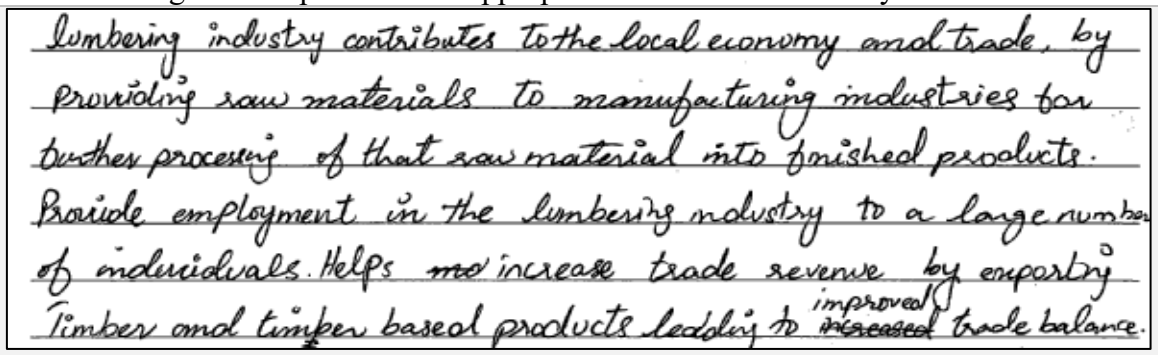
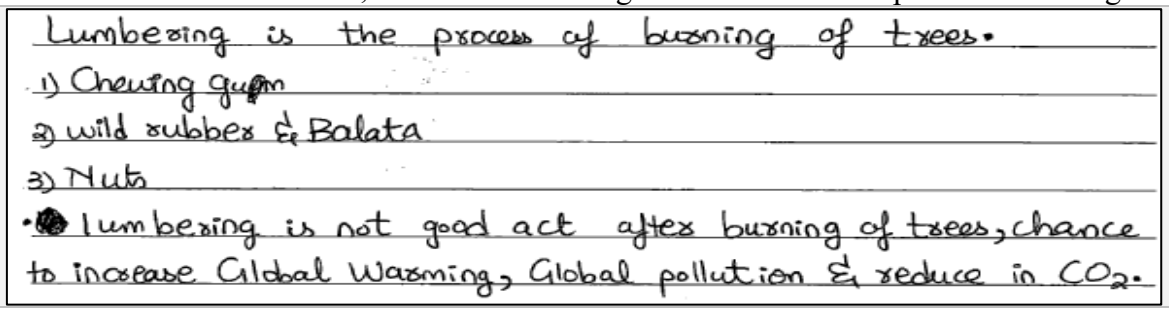
Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

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• Utilise the resource guide for additional materials		

Any Additional Suggestion:
Teachers are suggesting including **visual charts** and **job classification sorting activities** in the classroom. This will help them in retaining the classification in a better way and for longer duration. Teacher can also use **real-world case studies**, such as identifying the economic role of individuals in a business, hospital, or tech company, this would help candidates understand how different jobs align with economic activity levels.

Question No. 4

Question Text	In the remote region of Timberland, lumbering is the primary industry, that is supported by its rich and high-quality forests. Discuss THREE ways in which lumbering industry contributes to the local economy and trade.
SLO No.	4.3.3
SLO Text	Analyse the economic and commercial significance of lumbering.
Max Marks	3
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for each contribution (Three required)
Overall Performance	Most of the candidates scored good marks in this question. These responses highlighted contributions such as employment opportunities, source of FOREX, basic ingredient for furniture and connected industries.
Description of Better Responses	*Better responses* clearly defined economic benefits such as: "Lumbering provides raw materials to local furniture and paper industries, encouraging industrial growth," or "The industry creates employment for local people, which raises income levels and improves standards of living." Some also correctly mentioned "export of timber generating foreign exchange and boosting regional trade." These responses demonstrated a strong understanding of the topic and used appropriate economic vocabulary.
Image of Better Response	
Description of Weaker Responses	In contrast, most of the *weaker responses* failed to meet the requirement of the command word "Discuss" and merely listed bullet points such as "It helps the country" or "Lumber is useful," without explaining how or why. Some candidates only listed benefits without any elaboration, while others misunderstood the question entirely and described how trees grow or how forests are cut down, rather than focusing on the economic impact of lumbering.
Image of Weaker Response	

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

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Any Additional Suggestion:
Teachers should have guided candidates in breaking down the question prompt—particularly terms like "contributes," "local economy," and "trade." Using mind maps to connect industries with their economic effects and conducting case studies of real-world timber-producing regions like Canada or parts of northern Pakistan, could have helped candidates internalise these links. Encouraging candidates to use a structured paragraph model (Point → Explanation → Example) would have supported more organised writing.

Question No. 5

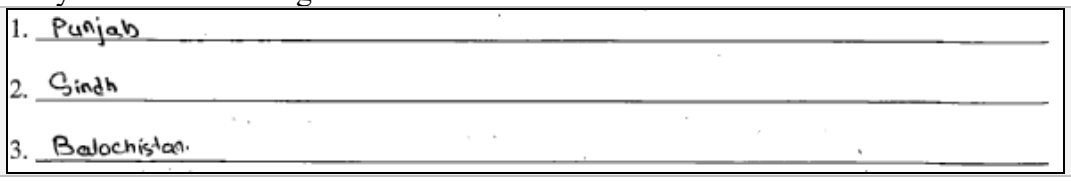
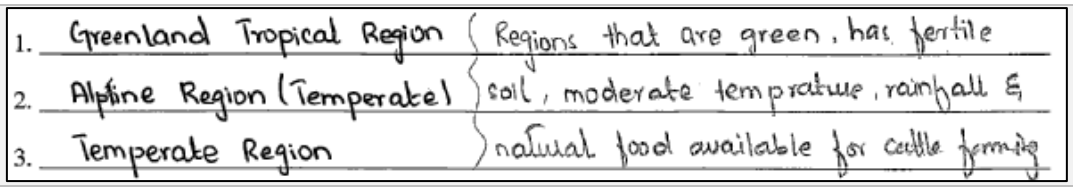
Question Text	List any THREE regions the famous for animal or cattle farming in Pakistan.
SLO No.	5.4.1
SLO Text	Identify the main regions of cattle farming on the map of Pakistan.
Max Marks	3
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give one mark for listing each famous region for cattle farming in Pakistan.
Overall Performance	This question was a straightforward and tested factual knowledge of regions in Pakistan known for cattle farming. Most candidates were able to attempt the question, but only a few gave specific and accurate responses. While many scored full marks, some answers revealed a lack of geographical awareness or confusion between agricultural areas and regions known for livestock farming.
Description of Better Responses	*Better responses* accurately listed regions such as Punjab (Sahiwal and Okara), Sindh (like Badin and Tharparkar), and Balochistan (like Zhob and Loralai). This reflected a good understanding of livestock-based economies across different provinces. Few candidates also mentioned Bahawalpur and Multan, which were acceptable due to their developed dairy and cattle farming sectors.
Image of Better Response	
Description of Weaker Responses	In contrast, *weaker responses* included vague or incorrect areas such as *Islamabad*, *Lahore*, or even entire provinces without any specific livestock relevance. Some candidates also listed crop-producing areas or mixed-up poultry farming with cattle farming. A few responses included non-Pakistani regions, showing poor familiarity with local geography.

Image of Weaker Response	

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

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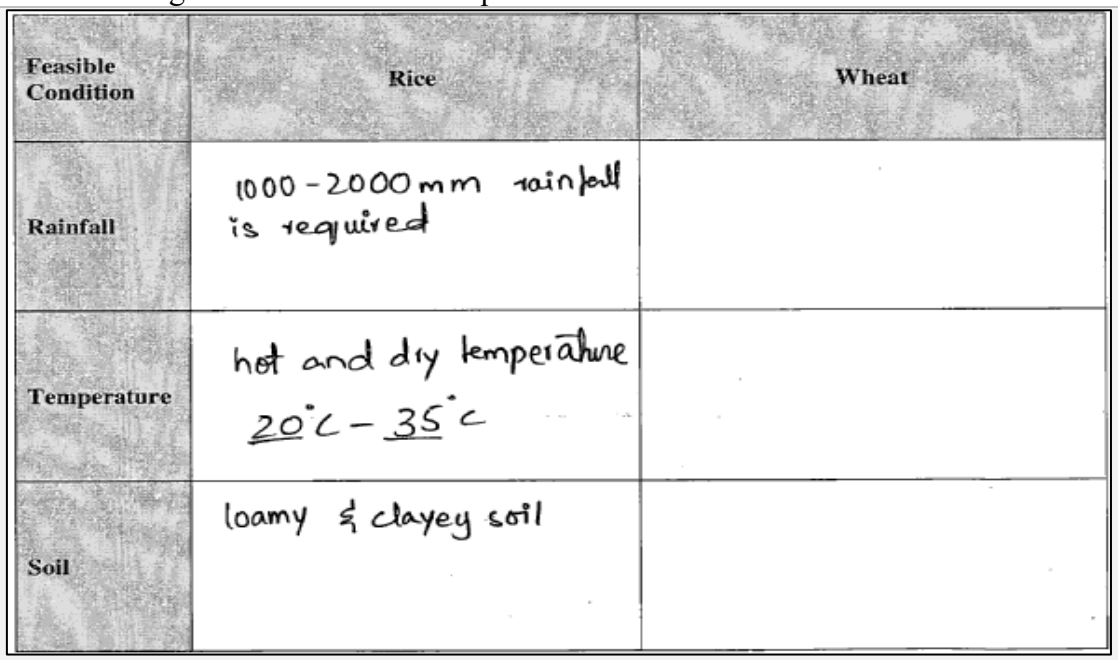
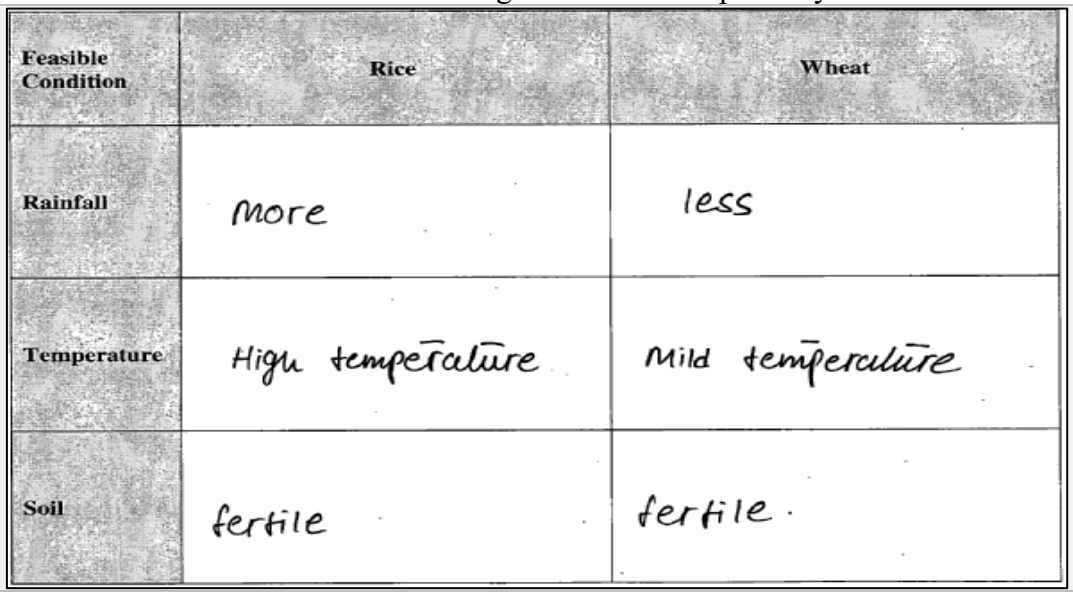
Any Additional Suggestion:
Teachers should incorporate **geography-based map activities** in class, where candidates label regions known for different types of agriculture, industry and farming. Use of **case studies**, such as the Sahiwal cattle breed or dairy industries in interior Sindh, could have made the topic more tangible. Regular quizzes, flashcards, or visual charts showing economic activities by region would have also reinforced this knowledge.

Question No. 6

Question Text	Describe the given feasible conditions for cultivation of any ONE of the crops in the given table.

Feasible Condition	Rice	Wheat
Rainfall		
Temperature		
Soil		

SLO No.	6.3.1
SLO Text	Explain the factors (feasible conditions) of cultivating crops (mentioned in sub-topic 6.3).
Max Marks	3
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for mentioning feasible conditions of any one of the crops.
Overall Performance	This was a knowledge-based question that was not properly addressed by most candidates. They were expected to write specific requirements (temperature, soil, rainfall) for the particular crop type rather than providing general information. Many candidates presented their responses in a general manner.

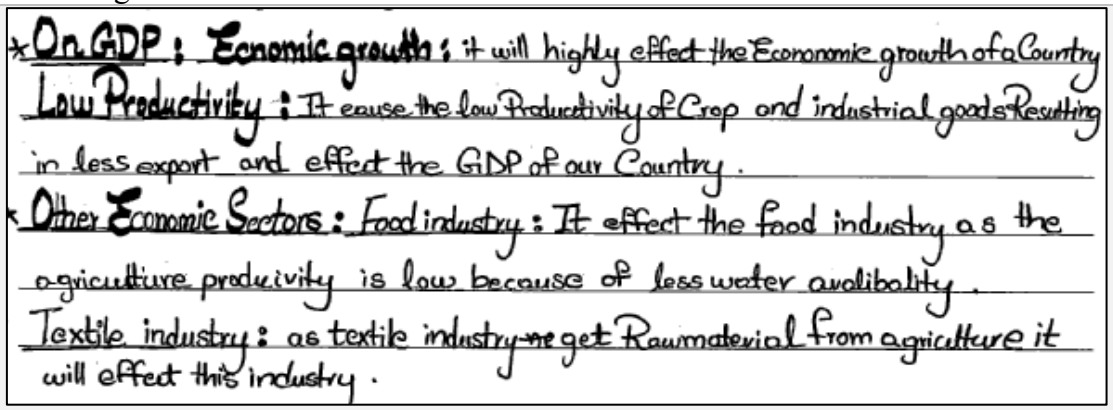
Description of Better Responses	*Better responses* showed accuracy and clarity. For example, candidates who chose **rice** correctly mentioned that it requires high rainfall (above 100 cm), high temperatures (above 25°C), and clayey or alluvial soil that retains water. Those who chose wheat described its need for moderate rainfall (around 50–75 cm), cooler growing temperatures (10–20°C), and well-drained loamy soil. These responses were well-structured and demonstrated clear understanding of climatic and soil requirements.
Image of Better Response	
Description of Weaker Responses	*Weaker responses* either gave generic answers such as *"rice needs water and hot weather"* or listed conditions without linking them to the crop. Some candidates provided completely reversed or mixed-up values, such as stating that wheat needs more rainfall than rice, or mentioned soil types that are not suitable for either crop. Others left one or more fields blank or described conditions without naming the selected crop clearly.
Image of Weaker Response	

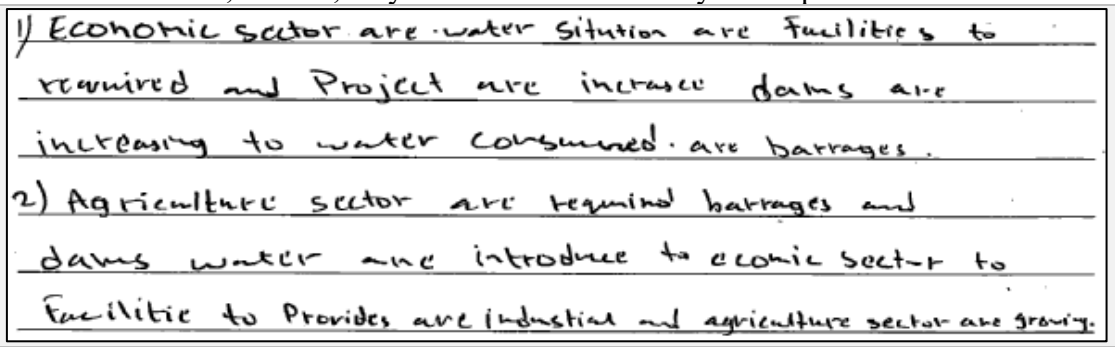
Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

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• Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level • Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share • Knowledge Platform videos • Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) • Practical Demonstration	

Any Additional Suggestion: Teachers are advised to use comparison charts in class to help candidates visualize and remember the differing requirements of major crops. Incorporating matching exercises, flashcards, or gap-fill tables could reinforce this knowledge. Real-world examples of rice-growing or wheat-growing regions in Pakistan (like Punjab for wheat or Sindh for rice) could have made learning more relevant.

Question No. 7	
Question Text	Suppose a country is experiencing severe drought conditions, significantly reducing water availability for agriculture and industries. Highlight any TWO impacts of the given situation on GDP and other economic sectors.
SLO No.	7.1.3
SLO Text	Analyse the economic and commercial role of water resources type with reference to GDP, economic development and contribution to other economic sectors.
Max Marks	4
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark awarded for GDP (Two required) Give ONE mark for economic sector (Two required).
Overall Performance	Candidates generally demonstrated a good understanding of the topic, as they included all the required details. In this question, candidates were able to mention any two impacts of the given situation on GDP and other economic sectors. Like sectors like agriculture, industry, energy production, and tourism, enhancing productivity and fostering economic growth
Description of Better Responses	*Better responses* clearly identified and explained the economic impact. For instance, candidates wrote that agricultural output would decline due to reduced irrigation, leading to lower GDP contribution from the primary sector**.** Others mentioned that industries dependent on water (like food processing or textiles) would face production slowdowns, causing job losses and a fall in exports. These answers correctly linked the environmental issue to sectoral performance and national income, showing the ability to apply textbook knowledge in a real-world scenario.
Image of Better Response	
Description of Weaker Responses	*Weaker responses* exhibited an incomplete or superficial understanding of the concept. Many candidates were unable to align their answers with the specific requirements of the

	question. The points mentioned in their responses failed to address both GDP and other economic sectors; instead, they tended to focus on only one aspect.
Image of Weaker Response	

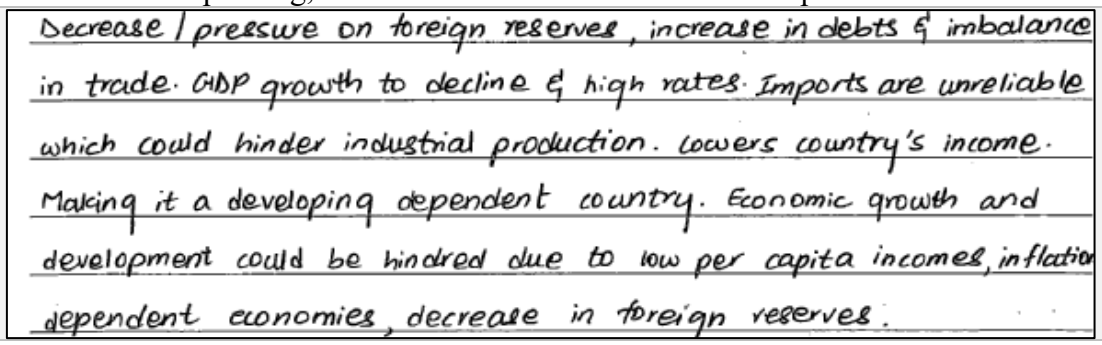
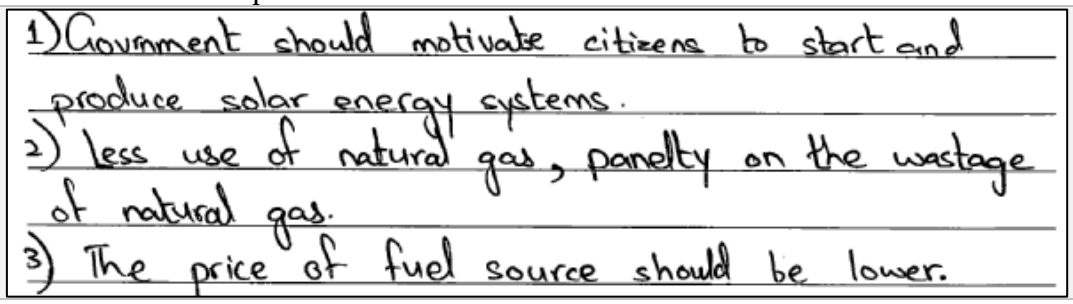
Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

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Any Additional Suggestion: Teachers are advised to use scenario-based discussions and case studies of countries like Pakistan or Ethiopia that have experienced drought. Encouraging candidates to use cause-and-effect chains (e.g., drought → lower crop yield → reduced exports → lower GDP) would have helped them develop analytical thinking. Additionally, group activities where candidates analyse how different sectors (agriculture, industry, services) respond to environmental shocks would strengthen their ability to think economically. Practicing writing short analytical paragraphs using economic terms like GDP, output, productivity, sectoral decline, and employment would also improve quality of written responses.

Question No. 8

Question Text	Pakistan's energy sector hampers economic growth despite the increase in power generation since 2013. The key issues include expensive fuel sources, reliance on imported energy, chronic natural gas shortages, substantial sector debt and outdated transmission and distribution systems. These challenges lead to significant economic hurdles in trade and commerce. With reference to GDP and economic development, describe any THREE challenges the given situation will bring to overall economic growth.
SLO No.	8.3.4
SLO Text	Analyse the economic and commercial role of power resources (with reference to GDP, economic development and contribution to other economic sectors).
Max Marks	3
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give one mark to each economic challenge student analyses due to shortage of power. (Three required)

Overall Performance	This question, which focused on the causes of the power crisis in Pakistan, was well answered by many candidates. The majority of responses appropriately highlighted the relevant challenges such as high production cost, infrastructural inefficiency, economic condition, decreased FDI etc. However, weaker responses focused on suggestions, which were not required for this question. Despite being conceptually straightforward, candidates' performance did not entirely align with the question's perceived simplicity.
Description of Better Responses	*Better responses* clearly addressed the specific challenges highlighted in the prompt and linked them to measurable economic effects. For example, candidates explained how expensive fuel and import dependency increases the cost of production, reducing industrial competitiveness and limiting GDP growth. Others highlighted how power shortages disrupt industrial output, leading to lower productivity and job losses, which in turn slow down economic growth. A few strong answers also mentioned how sector debt diverts public funds from development projects, affecting long-term infrastructure and education spending, which are vital for sustainable development.
Image of Better Response	 Decrease / pressure on foreign reserves, increase in debts & imbalance in trade. GDP growth to decline & high rates. Imports are unreliable which could hinder industrial production. Lowers country's income. Making it a developing dependent country. Economic growth and development could be hindred due to low per capita incomes, inflation dependent economies, decrease in foreign reserves.
Description of Weaker Responses	Most of the *weaker responses* showed a lack of understanding of the question. These candidates highlighted general challenges faced by an economy, while ignoring the specific aspect related to the power and energy sector. Additionally, a few responses listed points directly from the question (e.g., fuel is expensive, gas is short) but did not explain how these cause a slowdown in economic performance**.** A few misunderstood the question and wrote about environmental issues or general power saving tips instead of economic consequences.
Image of Weaker Response	 1) Government should motivate citizens to start and produce solar energy systems. 2) less use of natural gas, panelty on the wastage of natural gas. 3) The price of fuel source should be lower.

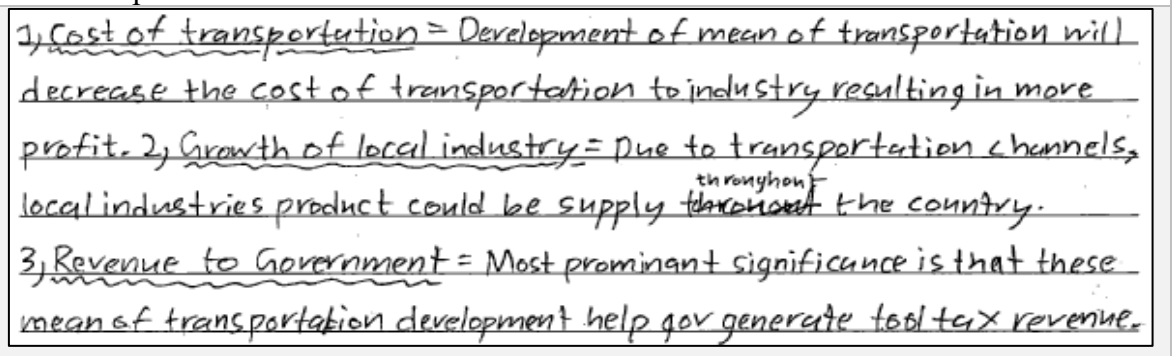
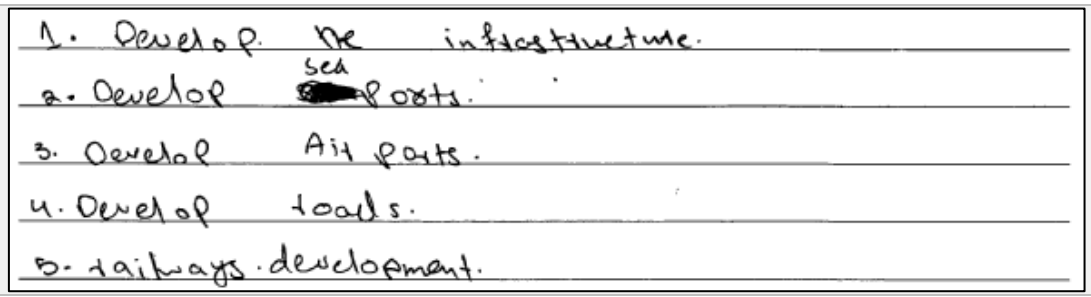
Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

Maximising SLO Achievement	Preferred Pedagogy Used for this SLO	Assessment Strategies
• Identify the expectation of command words (use Command Word Guide) • Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level • Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review of past paper questions on the concept	• Story Board • Cause and Effect • Fish and Bone • Concept Mapping • Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share • Knowledge Platform videos • Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) • Practical Demonstration	• Past paper questions • Discussion on E-Marking Notes

• Utilise the resource guide for additional materials		

Any Additional Suggestion: Teachers are advised to use data-driven discussions using Pakistan's energy sector as a real-world case study. Candidates would have benefited from activities that break down complex issues into chains of economic impact (e.g., power shortage → lower industrial output → reduced exports → lower GDP)

Question No.9

Question Text	Describe any THREE points of significance of development of 'means of transportation' with respect to trade and commerce activities.
SLO No.	10.3.5
SLO Text	Analyse the significance of development of means of transportation (with reference to GDP, economic development and contribution to other economic sectors).
Max Marks	3
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE Mark for each significance. (Three required)
Overall Performance	Overall, most of the candidates did exceptionally well, these responses mentioned points like increased productivity, efficiency, wider market access and employment opportunities whereas few candidates were awarded less marks. A score of zero was assigned to candidates who did not attempt the question.
Description of Better Responses	*Better responses* accurately described how transportation reduces cost and time of delivery**,** improves connectivity between producers and markets**,** and expands trade by enabling the movement of goods both domestically and internationally. Some candidates effectively explained that better roads, railways, and ports encourage investment, lower logistical expenses, and help reduce regional economic gaps. These answers used economic terms and showed understanding of how infrastructure contributes to business efficiency and market expansion.
Image of Better Response	 1) Cost of transportation = Development of mean of transportation will decrease the cost of transportation to industry resulting in more profit. 2) Growth of local industry = Due to transportation channels, local industries product could be supply throughout the country. 3) Revenue to Government = Most prominant significance is that these mean of transportation development help gov generate tool tax revenue.
Description of Weaker Responses	*Weaker responses* included vague or generic ideas such as *"transport helps people move"* or *"it is important for business"* without explaining how that supports trade or commerce. Some candidates repeated the same idea in different words, while others focused entirely on social benefits of transport, such as tourism or convenience, which strayed from the core focus on economic significance. A few answers simply listed types of transport rather than their role in trade.
Image of Weaker Response	 1. Develop the infrastructure. 2. Develop sea ports. 3. Develop Air ports. 4. Develop roads. 5. railways development.

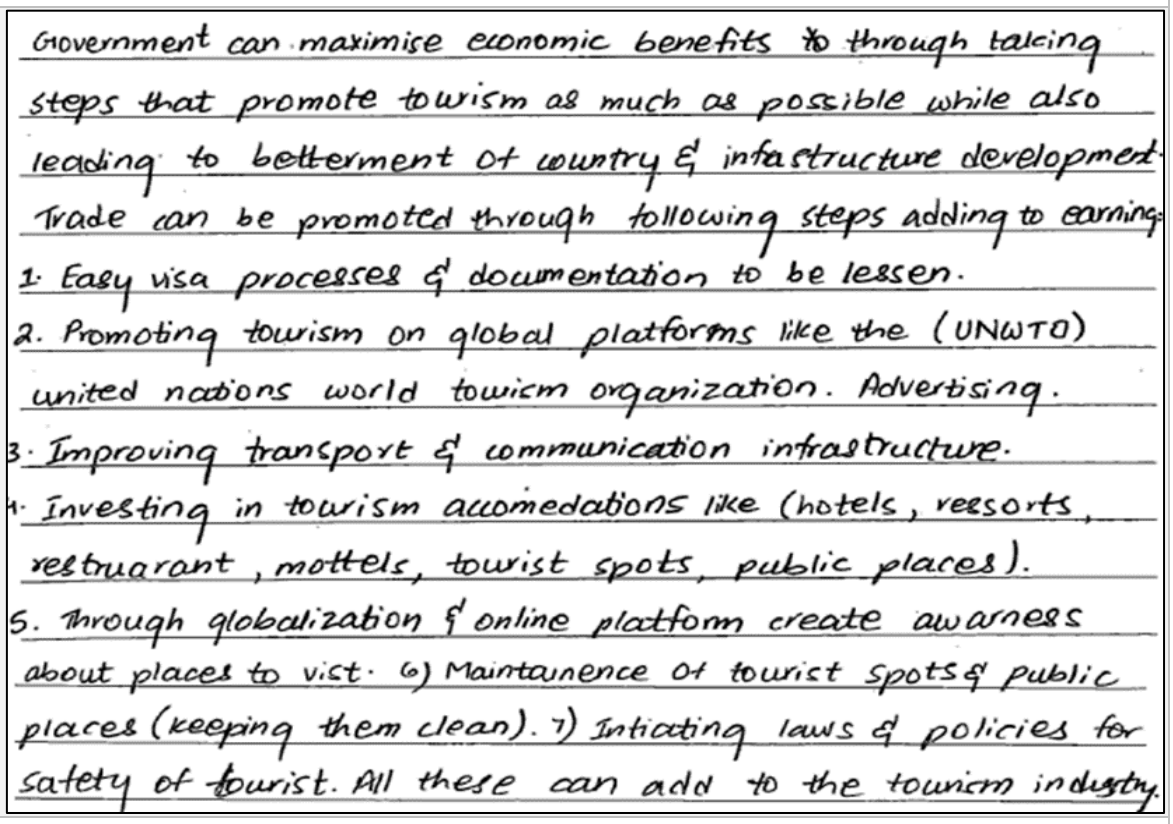
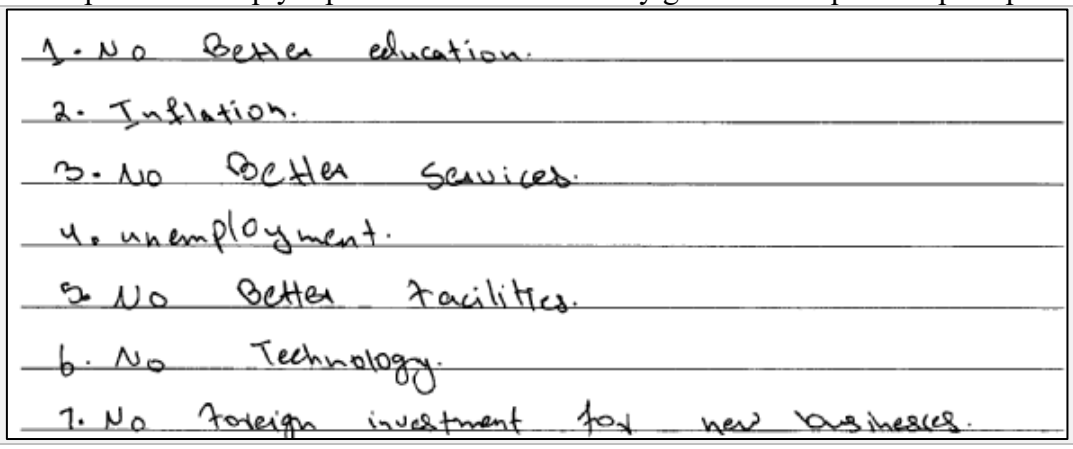
Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

Maximising SLO Achievement	Preferred Pedagogy Used for this SLO	Assessment Strategies
• Identify the expectation of command words (use Command Word Guide) • Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level • Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review of past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Story Board • Cause and Effect • Fish and Bone • Concept Mapping • Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share • Knowledge Platform videos • Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) • Practical Demonstration	• Past paper questions • Discussion on E-Marking Notes

Any Additional Suggestion: Teachers are suggested to use real-world trade scenarios to show the link between improved transportation and commercial success—such as how the development of CPEC or motorways in Pakistan has enhanced regional trade. Classroom discussions using visual aids like supply chain diagrams could have helped candidates understand how goods move from producers to consumers.

DETAILED COMMENTS
Extended Response Questions (ERQs)
Either / OR
Question No. 10a

Question Text	The travel and tourism sector's total contribution to Pakistan's GDP was 5.9 percent in 2022 with a provision of 4.2 million jobs. This is a sub-optimal information in view of considering the diverse tourist sites located across the country. Pakistan attracted US$ 16 billion in visitor spending in 2022 which is projected to touch US$ 30 billion in 2033. (source:https://www.worldbank.org/en/news/feature/2023/11/01/promoting-responsible-tourism-in-Pakistan-s-north) Considering the surge in the tourism industry, suggest any SEVEN steps that the government can take to maximise the economic benefits.
SLO No.	9.7.6
SLO Text	Suggest ways to improve the tourism industry in Pakistan.
Max Marks	7
Cognitive Level	A
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for mentioning each factor (Not more than TWO marks would be given in total for mentioning.) Give ONE mark for explanation (Explanation of three factors required).
Overall Performance	Most of the candidates did not opt for this part. From the candidates who opted this question the performance was impressive addressing all major suggestions the government should consider enhancing Pakistan's tourism sector. Like, promotion of cultural heritage, development of human resources, streamline visa processing, investment in infrastructure etc.
Description of Better Responses	*Better responses* included diverse and practical steps such as developing transport and communication infrastructure in tourist regions, launching international tourism marketing campaigns, improving security and safety measures, introducing vocational training for hospitality staff, providing tax incentives for investors in tourism-related businesses,

	ensuring conservation of cultural and natural heritage sites, and developing eco-friendly tourism projects to ensure sustainability. These candidates clearly understood how tourism could create jobs, generate foreign exchange, attract investment, and stimulate local economies.
Image of Better Response	
Description of Weaker Responses	*Weaker responses* often repeated the same point in different wording (e.g., "build more hotels," "make hotels better," "increase places to stay") or listed vague suggestions such as "promote tourism" without explaining how. Several candidates failed to explain the economic impact of their proposed steps, while others gave socially focused ideas without connecting them to GDP growth, employment, or trade**.** A few candidates listed fewer than seven points or simply rephrased what was already given in the question prompt.
Image of Weaker Response	

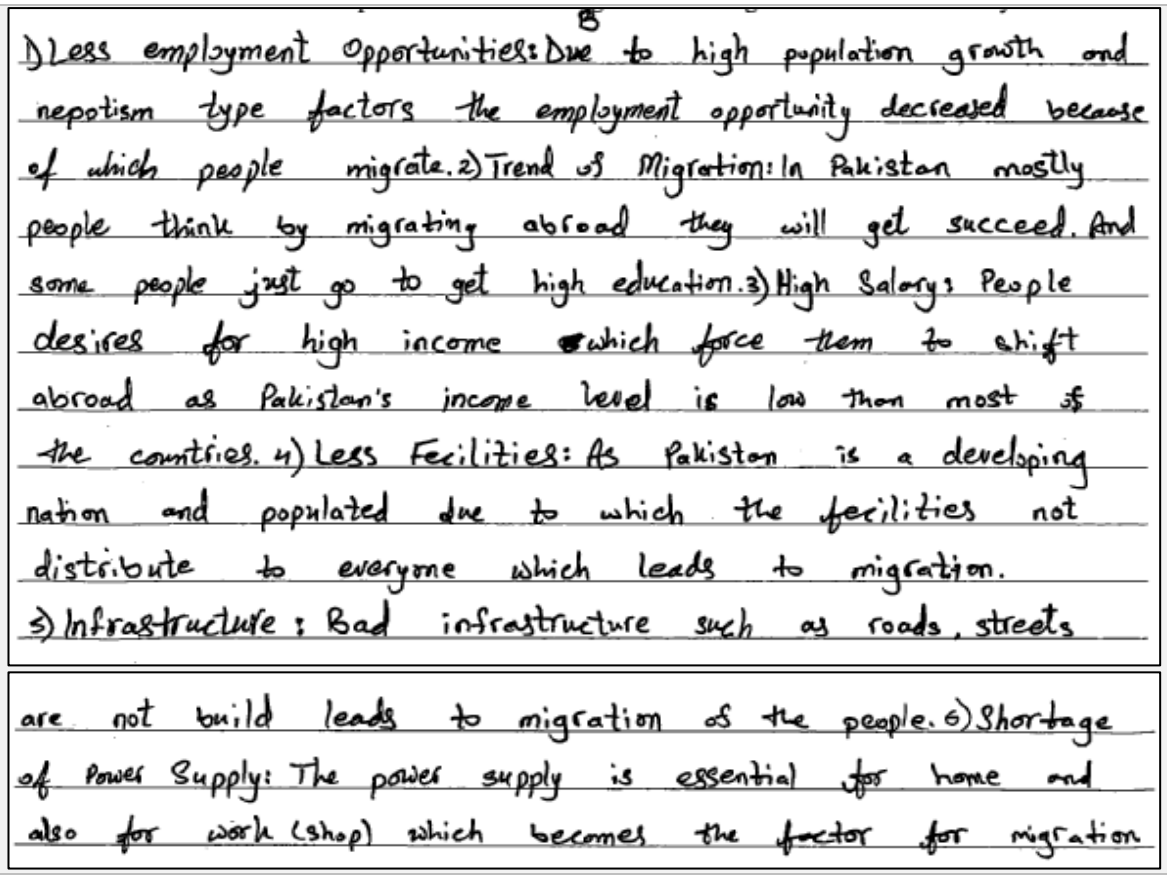
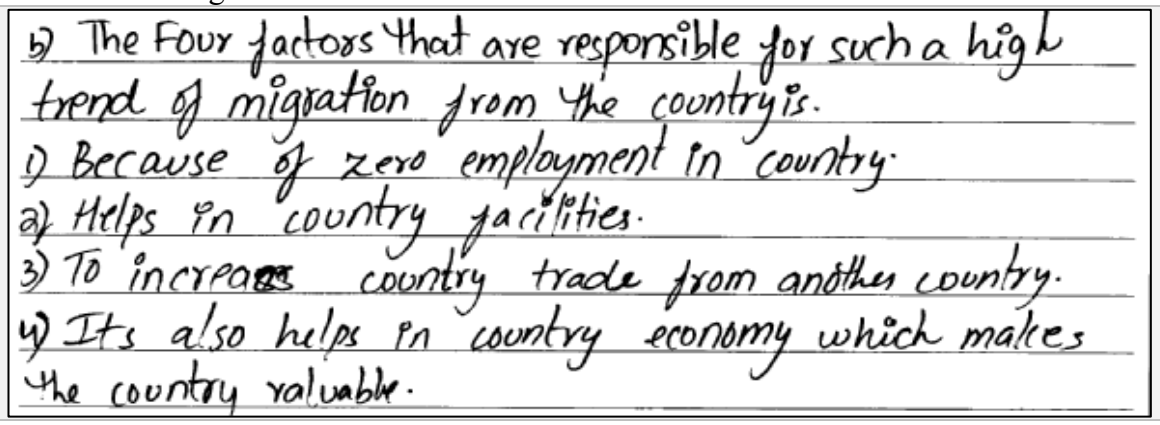
Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

Maximising SLO Achievement	Preferred Pedagogy Used for this SLO	Assessment Strategies
• Identify the expectation of command words (use Command Word Guide) • Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level	• Story Board • Cause and Effect • Fish and Bone • Concept Mapping • Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share	• Past paper questions • Discussion on E-Marking Notes

• Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Knowledge Platform videos • Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) • Practical Demonstration	

Any Additional Suggestion: Teachers are suggested to provided case studies of tourism development from countries that transformed their economies through strategic tourism growth (e.g., Malaysia, UAE, Turkey). A classroom policy design activity where candidates role-play as government planners could have made the topic more interactive and practical.

Question No. 10b	
Question Text	Pakistan is one of the countries that sends the most workers abroad for employment, with over 11 million people migrating to more than 50 countries through official procedures as of December 2019. In 2020, nearly 6.3 million Pakistani immigrants were living abroad, making Pakistan one of the top ten immigrant populations in the world. (source: https://www.ilo.org/regions-and-countries/asia-and-pacific/areas-work/labour-migration) The given information reflects that Pakistan's rate of migration is rising rapidly. Discuss any FOUR factors that are responsible for such a high trend of migration from the country.
SLO No.	11.2.2
SLO Text	Discuss the factors of migration (i.e. political, social and economic).
Max Marks	7
Cognitive Level	A
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for mentioning each factor. (Not more than THREE marks would be awarded for mentioning. Give an additional mark on discussing each mentioned point. (FOUR required).
Overall Performance	This question evaluated candidates understanding of labour migration trends and the socioeconomic factors contributing to the high emigration rates from Pakistan. Most of the candidates attempted part (b) and provided excellent responses, identifying key reasons for migration with a good level of insight. However, a few responses were limited to general observations and lacked clear analysis or strong connections between the identified factors and the increasing trend of outward migration.
Description of Better Responses	*Better responses* included well-reasoned points such as: lack of employment opportunities within Pakistan, better income prospects abroad, political instability or law and order issues, and access to improved living standards or education opportunities overseas. Some candidates also mentioned remittances and family reunification as contributing motivations. These responses were supported with brief explanations showing how this push and pull factors have encouraged a growing number of Pakistanis to seek work and settlement abroad. These candidates used relevant economic and social vocabulary, making their answers structured and impactful.

Images of Better Response	
Description of Weaker Responses	In contrast, *weaker responses* were overly simplistic or repetitive. For example, candidates wrote vague statements like "people want a better life" or "they go for a good future" without elaborating on specific factors. Others listed similar points such as "no jobs," "no work," and "no income" as separate ideas, which showed limited development of thought. A few responses even misinterpreted the question by writing about internal migration within Pakistan or the problems faced by migrants abroad, rather than the causes of international migration.
Image of Weaker Response	

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

Maximising SLO Achievement	Preferred Pedagogy Used for this SLO	Assessment Strategies
• Identify the expectation of command words (use Command Word Guide) • Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level	• Story Board • Cause and Effect • Fish and Bone • Concept Mapping • Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share • Knowledge Platform videos	• Past paper questions • Discussion on E-Marking Notes

• Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review of past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) • Practical Demonstration	

Any Additional Suggestion: Teachers are suggested to use the following class activity to enhance analytical skills in candidates: Divide the class into two groups, one focusing on positive impacts and the other on negative impacts and for that instruct candidates to research the subject content. Guide candidates to actively participate in discussions by presenting their opinions supported by facts and data. Encourage candidates to take notes of their discussion points.

Annexure A: Pedagogies Used for Teaching the SLOs

Pedagogy: Storyboard
Description: A visual pedagogy that uses a series of illustrated panels to present a narrative, encouraging creativity and critical thinking. It helps learners organise ideas, sequence events, and comprehend complex concepts through storytelling.
Example: In a Literature class, candidates are tasked with creating storyboards to visually retell a novel. They draw key scenes, write captions, and present their stories to the class, enhancing their reading comprehension and fostering their imagination.

Pedagogy: Cause and Effect
Description: This pedagogy explores the relationships between actions and consequences. By analysing cause-and-effect relationships, learners develop a deeper understanding of how events are interconnected and how one action can lead to various outcomes.
Example: In a History class, candidates study the causes and effects of the Industrial Revolution. They research and discuss how technological advancements in manufacturing led to significant societal changes, such as urbanisation and labour reform movements.

Pedagogy: Fish and Bone
Description: A method that breaks down complex topics into main ideas (the fish) and supporting details (the bones). This visual approach enhances comprehension by highlighting essential concepts and their relevant explanations.
Example: During a Biology class on human anatomy, the teacher uses the fish and bone technique to teach about the human skeletal system. Teacher presents the main components of the human skeleton (fish) and elaborates on each bone's structure and function (bones).

Pedagogy: Concept Mapping
Description: An effective way to visually represent relationships between ideas. Learners create diagrams connecting key concepts, aiding in understanding the overall structure of a subject and fostering retention.
Example: In a Psychology assignment, candidates use concept mapping to explore the various theories of personality. They interlink different theories, such as Freud's psychoanalysis, Jung's analytical psychology, and Bandura's social-cognitive theory, to see how they relate to each other.

Pedagogy: Audio Visual Resources
Description: Incorporating multimedia elements like videos, images, and audio into lessons. This approach caters to different learning styles, making educational content more engaging and memorable.
Example: In a General Science class, the teacher uses a documentary-style video to teach about the solar system. The video includes stunning visual animations of the planets, interviews with astronomers, and background music, enhancing candidates' interest and understanding of space.

Pedagogy: Think, Pair, and Share
Description: A collaborative learning technique where candidates ponder a question or problem individually, then discuss their thoughts in pairs or small groups before sharing with the entire class. It fosters active participation, communication skills, and diverse perspectives.
Example: In a Literature in English class, the teacher poses a thought-provoking question about a novel's moral dilemma. Candidates first reflect individually, then pair up to exchange their opinions, and finally participate in a lively class discussion to explore different viewpoints.

Pedagogy: Questioning Technique (Socratic Approach)
Description: Based on Socratic dialogue, this method stimulates critical thinking by posing thought-provoking questions. It encourages learners to explore ideas, justify their reasoning, and discover knowledge through a process of inquiry.
Example: In an Ethics class, the instructor uses the Socratic approach to lead a discussion on the meaning of justice. By asking a series of probing questions, the candidates engage in a deeper exploration of ethical principles and societal values.

Pedagogy: Practical Demonstration
Description: A hands-on approach where learners observe real-life applications of theories or skills. Practical demonstrations enhance comprehension, skill acquisition, and problem-solving abilities by bridging theoretical concepts with real-world scenarios.
Example: In a Food and Nutrition class, the instructor demonstrates the proper technique for filleting a fish. Candidates observe and then practice the skill themselves, learning the practical application of knife skills and culinary precision.

(**Note:** The examples provided in this annexure serve as illustrations of various pedagogies. It is important to understand that these pedagogies are versatile and can be applied across subjects in numerous ways. Feel free to adapt and explore these techniques creatively to enhance learning outcomes in your specific context.)

Acknowledgments

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